

I. Ancient History of India

Stone Age

*The period without documented evidence of its history is called the **Prehistoric period**. Proto-historic period is the period having shreds of evidence of a script which is still not deciphered. **Proto-historic** refers to the period between prehistoric and historical periods. *The time after which we get a documented description is called **historic period**. *The Stone Age comes under the Prehistoric period. *Indus valley civilization and Copper Age culture come under the Proto-historic period. *The historical period starts from around 6th century B.C. *In India, the research on Stone Age Civilization started at first in **1863**. The whole Stone Age has been categorized into three parts on the basis of difference of tools used. These are **Palaeolithic period, Mesolithic period and Neolithic period**.

*Palaeolithic Period is further categorized into three periods on the same basis-

(i) **The Lower Palaeolithic period** -Handaxe, Cleaver, Chopper, etc.

(ii) **The Middle Palaeolithic period**- Points, Borer, Scraper

(iii) **The Upper Palaeolithic period** - Burins

*Chopper-Chopping pebble pieces of tools were at first obtained from **Sohan river valley** of Punjab (Pakistan). At first, hand-axe pieces of equipment were found in **Pallavaram** and **Attirampakkam** near Chennai (Tamil Nadu). Other tools of this culture are cleaver, scraper, etc. ***Robert Bruce Foote** was a British geologist and archaeologist. *The expedition of Yale Cambridge team under the leadership of De. Terra did the most important research in **Sohan valley** in 1935. *In **Belan valley**, the research was carried under the direction of G.R. Sharma of Allahabad University. Nearly 44 archaeological sites were found in this valley which is related to the Lower Palaeolithic period. *Apart from tools, the statue of **bone-made Mother Goddess** of this age was obtained from Lohanda Nala region of Belan Valley which is currently preserved at the Kaushambi museum.

*The life of Palaeolithic people was completely natural. They were primarily dependent on hunting. They were **unfamiliar with fire**, so they ate raw meat. Palaeolithic people were **unfamiliar with farming and animal husbandry**. *We came to know about Mesolithic period only after A.C.L. Carlleyle discovered (1867 A.D.) the Rock Painting from Vindhya region.

*According to the excavated evidence, the **domestication of animals** began in the Mesolithic period. The earliest pieces of evidence of domestication of animals in India have been found at Adamgarh (Narmadapuram, M.P.) and **Bagor** (Bhilwara, Rajasthan). *A large number of implements made of bones and horns have been found from the Mesolithic site, **Mahadaha** (located in Pratapgarh district of U.P.). The book titled 'Puratatva Vimarsh' written by Dr. Jai Narayan Pandey describes various pointed objects and ornaments made of bones which have been reported from Sarai Nahar Rai, Damdama and Mahadaha. ***Damdama** is a Mesolithic site in Pratapgarh district of Uttar Pradesh. In Damdama, **41 human graves** have been found. Out of these graves, 5 are **double burials**. One **triple burial** grave is also found here. A grave with **four human skeletons** has been found at Sarai Nahar Rai.

*The **Megaliths** usually refer to the burials made up of large stones in graveyards away from the habitation area. A large fraction of these is assumed to be associated with burial or post-burial rituals including memorials for those whose remains may or may not be available. Some of these are; Chamber tomb, Dolmens, Stone alignment, Stone circle (cromlech), Pit-circles, etc. *According to 'Puratatva Vimarsh' by Dr. J.N. Pandey **17 human skeletons** were found from rock shelter **1** of Lekhahiya in the Vindhya region. Some of these were in relatively pristine condition while most of the others were warped. *According to John R. Lucas of the University of Oregon (USA), remnants of **27 human skeletons** were found in Lekhahiya. *The rock shelters of **Bhimbetka** are situated in the Raisen district of Madhya Pradesh. UNESCO has included the rock art of Bhimbetka in the list of its World Heritage Sites. These caves exhibit the earliest traces of human life on the Indian subcontinent and include pictures of an elephant, sambhar, deer, etc.

***Grains** were first ever produced in **Neolithic Age**. It was the time when people were introduced to agriculture. **Koldihwa** and **Mehrgarh** were the two Neolithic sites from where clear pieces evidence of rice and wheat have been found. *There are mainly eight types of food grains consumed by modern human society, namely-barley, wheat, maize, millet, sorghum, mustard, oat and rice. These crops were present in the form of weeds in different areas, which were later grown as seeds by human beings at different places, at different times. *According to the latest research, the earliest evidence of agriculture in the Indian

sub-continent was reported from the **Lahuradewa** site in Sant Kabir Nagar district, Uttar Pradesh. The evidence of human activity and beginning of rice cultivation at this site dates back to around **9000-7000 BC**. *Significantly before this research, the earlier evidence of wheat was found at **Mehrgarh** (located in Balochistan, Pakistan) belonging to around 7000 BC and the earliest evidence of rice is known to be near the bank of the river Belan, district Prayagraj, from where rice bran was found dating back to 6500 BC. *The cultural remains from the Stone Age to Harappan Civilization have been found in **Mehrgarh** located in Balochistan (Pakistan).

*The **Burzahom** site is a prehistoric settlement in the village of the same name in Kashmir valley. Both human and animal skeletons were found here with trepanning (bored holes) marks. In many pits, bones of dogs and antlered deer were found along with human skeletons. The skeletons of humans were found in the burial pits in a sitting position along with bones of animals. *The first excavation at the Burzahom site was carried out by Helmut de Terra and Dr. Thomas Paterson in 1935 A.D. *The people of **Jorwe** culture lived in large rectangular houses with wattle and daub walls and thatched roofs. They believed in **life after death** and therefore buried the dead inside the houses under the floor. Children were buried in two urns that were joined mouth-to-mouth and set horizontally in the pit, while adults were placed in a supine position with their **head towards the north** (north to south). These sites were found in **Daimabad, Inamgaon, Chandoli, Nevasa** etc. *The 'Ash mounds' have been found from a Neolithic site **Sangana Kallu** located in Ballari district in Karnataka. They have also been found in Piklihal and Utnur. These ash mounds are the burnt relics of seasonal camps of Neolithic herdsman community.

*Fire was first used in the Neolithic period.

*Copper was the first metal used. Copper Age is also known as the **Chalcolithic Age**. The age in which instruments of copper were used in addition to stone is called as Chalcolithic Age. *Settlements of Chalcolithic period in India were found in South-East Rajasthan, Western Madhya Pradesh, Western Maharashtra and South-East India. *Navdatoli has revealed excellent evidence of both round and rectangular residential structures which are located near Khargone district (M.P.). The former measures about 3m in diameter and the latter is 2m × 2.2m. *The roofs were probably made of hay, tree branches and leaves and were supported on massive wooden posts, 22cm in diameter, raised at regular intervals around the huts. *The open spaces between the posts were provided with mud-plastered bamboo screens. *The house floors were made up of silt clay and river gravel, with the surface coated with lime. The huts were provided with one or two-mouthed 'chulhas' as well as storage jars and other earthen vessels.

***Ochre-Coloured Pottery** (known to archaeologists as OCP) as the name implies, its main distinguishing feature was its ochre colour. Other characteristics are its porous character and

the fact that it is invariably worn out at the edges. Most of its evidence is mainly found in **Atranjikhhera** and **Hastinapur**.

*The **Archaeological Survey of India (ASI)**, under the Ministry of Culture, is a premier organization for the archaeological research and protection of the cultural heritage of the nation. In **1871 AD**, the Archaeological Survey was established as a separate department and **Alexander Cunningham** was appointed as its first Director-General. In **1901 AD**, during the tenure of **Lord Curzon**, it was centralized as Archaeological Survey of India and **John Marshall** assumed office in 1902 as its Director-General. *The **National Museum of Mankind known as Indira Gandhi Rastriya Manav Sangrahalaya** is located in **Bhopal (M.P.)**. It is an autonomous organization under the Ministry of Culture.

1. **Robert Bruce Foote, who discovered first Palaeolithic tool in India, was a/an –**

- | | |
|-------------------|-------------------|
| (a) Geologist | (b) Archaeologist |
| (c) Paleobotanist | (d) Historian |

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a & b)

According to Encyclopaedia Britannica, Robert Bruce Foote was a British geologist and archaeologist. He is considered as the father of Indian pre-history. He was associated with the Geological Survey of India and documented the antiquities of the Stone Age. Hence, both options (a) and (b) can be considered as correct.

2. **The three-age system, divided into stone, bronze and iron from the collection of Copenhagen museum was coined by –**

- | | |
|-------------|-------------|
| (a) Thomsen | (b) Lubbock |
| (c) Taylor | (d) Childe |

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

The three age system- Stone, Bronze and Iron from the collection of Copenhagen museum was coined by Christian Jurgensen Thomsen.

3. **With reference to the Indian History, Alexander Rea, A. H. Longhurst, Robert Sewell, James Burgess and Walter Elliot were associated with**

- | |
|--|
| (a) Archaeological excavations |
| (b) Establishment of English Press in Colonial India |
| (c) Establishment of Churches in Princely States |
| (d) Construction of railways in Colonial India |

I.A.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

Alexander Rea, A.H. Longhurst, Robert Sewell, James Burgess and Walter Elliot were associated with archaeological excavations. They primarily worked in the field of South Indian history.

4. According to the excavated evidence, the domestication of animals began in –
 (a) Lower Palaeolithic period
 (b) Middle Palaeolithic period
 (c) Upper Palaeolithic period
 (d) Mesolithic period

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (d)

According to the excavated evidence, the domestication of animals began in the Mesolithic period. The earliest pieces of evidence of domestication of animals in India have been found at Adamgarh (Narmadapuram, M.P.) and Bagor (Bhilwara, Rajasthan).

5. In Mesolithic context, evidence of animal domestication has been found at :

- (a) Langhnaj (b) Birbhanpur
 (c) Adamgarh (d) Chopani Mando

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

6. From which one of the following sites have bone implements been found?

- (a) Chopani-Mando (b) Kakoria
 (c) Mahadaha (d) Sarai Nahar Rai

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (c & d)

A large number of implements made of bones and horns have been found from the Mesolithic site-Mahadaha and Sarai Nahar Rai (located in Pratapgarh district of U.P.). The book titled 'Puratatva Vimarsh' written by Dr. Jai Narayan Pandey describes various pointed objects and ornaments made of bones which have been reported from Sarai Nahar Rai, Damdama and Mahadaha.

7. Bone ornaments in the Mesolithic context in India have been obtained from –

- (a) Sarai Nahar Rai (b) Mahadaha
 (c) Lekhahia (d) Chopani Mando

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (a & b)

See the explanation of above question.

8. Arrange the following Mesolithic sites geographically in order from west to east –

1. Paisra 2. Lekhahia
 3. Birbhanpur 4. Mahadaha

Select the correct answer from the code given below :

Code :

- (a) 4, 2, 3 and 1 (b) 1, 4, 3 and 2
 (c) 4, 2, 1 and 3 (d) 2, 4, 1 and 3

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2021

Ans. (c)

Mesolithic sites in order from west to east geographically– Mahadaha (Pratapgarh, UP), Lekhahia (Mirzapur, UP), Paisra (Bihar) and Birbhanpur (W. Bengal)

9. Three human skeletons in a single grave were recovered at –

- (a) Sarai Nahar Rai (b) Damdama
 (c) Mahadaha (d) Langhnaj

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

Damdama is a Mesolithic site in Pratapgarh district of Uttar Pradesh. In Damdama, 41 human graves were found. Out of these graves, 5 are double burials. One triple burial grave is also found here. A grave with four human skeletons has been found at Sarai Nahar Rai.

10. The cultivation of cereals first started in -

- (a) Neolithic Age (b) Mesolithic Age
 (c) Palaeolithic Age (d) Proto-Historic Age

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (a)

Grains were first ever produced in Neolithic Age. It was the time when people were introduced to agriculture. Koldihwa and Mehrgarh were the two Neolithic archaeological sites from where clear pieces of evidence of ricebran and wheat have been found.

11. The earliest evidence of man in India is found in

- (a) Nilgiri Hills (b) Shiwalik Hills
 (c) Nallamala Hills (d) Narmada Valley

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (d)

In India, the first evidence of man was found in Narmada valley region of Madhya Pradesh. It was discovered in 1982 A.D.

12. The first Human Fossil was found from which River Valley of India?

- (a) Ganga Valley
 (b) Yamuna Valley
 (c) Narmada Valley
 (d) Tapti Valley
 (e) None of the above/more than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam-2020

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

13. The first cereal used by man was :

- (a) Wheat (b) Rice
(c) Barley (d) Sorghum

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

There are mainly eight types of food grains consumed by modern human society, namely barley, wheat, maize, millet, sorghum, mustard, oat and rice. These plants were present in the form of weeds in different areas, which were later grown as seeds by human beings at different places, in different times. Although, barley was the first grain to be cultivated by human beings during 8000 B.C. in western Asian countries located between the northeast Mediterranean Sea and Iran. Later, in the same area, wheat was also cultivated around 8000 B.C.

14. The earliest evidence of agriculture in Indian sub-continent comes from –

- (a) Koldihwa (b) Lahuradeva
(c) Mehrgarh (d) Tokwa

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

According to the latest research, the earliest evidence of agriculture in Indian sub-continent has been reported from the Lahuradeva site in Sant Kabir Nagar district, Uttar Pradesh. The evidence of human activity and beginning of rice cultivation at this site dates back to around 9000-7000 B.C. Significantly before this research, the earlier evidence of wheat was found at Mehrgarh (located in Balochistan, Pakistan) belonging to around 7000 B.C. and the earliest evidence of rice is known to be near the bank of the river Belan, district Prayagraj, from where rice bran was found dating back to 6500 B.C. With above reference, if Lahuradeva is one option, then it will be the correct answer, but if Lahuradeva is not an option, then Mehrgarh would be the right answer.

15. The earliest evidence of agriculture in the Indian Sub-continent has been obtained from –

- (a) Brahmagiri (b) Burzahom
(c) Koldihwa (d) Mehrgarh

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

16. The earliest evidence of Agriculture in Indian subcontinent is found at

- (a) Lothal (b) Harappa
(c) Mehrgarh (d) Mundigak

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

17. During the Neolithic Age the earliest evidence of the origin of agriculture has been found at which of the following places in the North-Western region of Indian sub-continent?

- (a) Munidgark (b) Mehargarh
(c) Damb Sadat (d) Balakot
(e) Amri

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

18. The earliest evidence of animal domestication and agriculture in India has come from

- (a) Anjira
(b) Damb Sadat
(c) Kili Gul Muhammad
(d) Mehrgarh
(e) None of the above/more than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre)-2018

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

19. With reference to the cultural heritage of Uttar Pradesh, which of the following statement/s is/are correct?

- (1) The oldest evidence of agriculture in the global context has been obtained from many excavated sites in this region.
(2) The oldest cultivated food grains are barley and paddy.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below – Code -

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre.) 2021

Ans (c)

Uttar Pradesh has been blessed with a rich cultural heritage since prehistoric times. It is noteworthy that Koldihwa situated in the Belan River valley region of the state, has been considered to be the oldest evidence of paddy cultivation in the world for a long time. Similarly, Lahuradeva, which currently presents the oldest evidence of paddy cultivation, is also a part of Sant Kabir Nagar district of Uttar Pradesh. Hence statement (1) is correct. Evidence of the oldest agricultural grains barley and paddy has been found from many excavated sites of Uttar Pradesh, evidence of barley and paddy has been found from Mahagada and evidence of paddy has been found from Koldihwa.

20. Name the site which has revealed the earliest evidence of settled life ?

- (a) Dholavira (b) Kile Gul Mohammad
(c) Kalibangan (d) Mehrgarh

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (d)

Among the given options, the oldest evidence of permanent life has been found for the first time from Mehrgarh located in Kachhi plains of Balochistan, whose authentic date is around 7000 B.C., while the oldest date of Kile Gul Muhammad and Kalibangan is 4000 B.C. and 3500 B.C. respectively. Hence option (d) is correct option.

21. Which among the following sites provides evidence of domestication of animals in the Mesolithic period?

- (a) Odai (b) Bori
(c) Bagor (d) Lakhnia

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

The earliest pieces of evidence of the domestication of animals in India have been found at Adamgarh (Narmadapuram, M.P.) and Bagor (Bhilwara, Rajasthan).

22. Which one of the following periods is also known as Chalcolithic Age?

- (a) Old Stone Age (b) New Stone Age
(c) Copper Age (d) Iron Age

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

Copper Age is also known as the Chalcolithic Age. The age in which instruments of copper were used in addition to stone, is called as Copper Age.

23. Consider the following statements pertaining to the Ahar Civilization –

- A. The natives of Ahar knew copper smelting
B. Rice was unknown to them
C. Metal work was one of the means of economy of the Ahar
D. Black - Red coloured pottery has been found here, on which generally white coloured geometrical designs have been carved.

Choose the correct option –

- (a) A, C and D are correct (b) A and B are correct
(c) A, B and C are correct (d) C and D are correct

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre.) 2021

Ans. (a)

Ahar civilization belonged to Chalcolithic period and flourished around the Mewar region of Rajasthan. They used copper tools and evidence of copper smelting is present too. Hence (A) and (C) statements are correct. Rice was known to them hence (B) is wrong. Mostly black-red coloured pottery decorated with white geometric designs has been found here. Hence (D) is also correct.

24. Ahar or Banas culture was a contemporary of which culture?

- (a) Harappa culture
(b) Mughal period culture
(c) Mauryan period culture
(d) Gupta period culture

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

The Ahar-Banas culture (2100-1500 BC) was contemporary with the Harappan Civilisation. It flourished in the present day Mewar region of Rajasthan, particularly along the Banas River and its tributaries. Ahar, Gilund, Balathal are some of the prominent sites of this culture.

25. The cultural remains from Stone Age to Harappan Civilization have been obtained from which one of the following ancient sites?

- (a) Amri (b) Mehrgarh
(c) Kotdiji (d) Kalibangan

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (b)

The cultural remains from Stone Age to Harappan Civilization have been obtained from Mehrgarh located in Balochistan (Pakistan).

26. Excavation at Navdatoli was conducted by –

- (a) K.D. Bajpai (b) V.S. Wakankar
(c) H.D. Sankalia (d) Mortimer Wheeler

U.P. Lower Spl. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

Navdatoli has revealed excellent evidence of both round and rectangular residential structures which are located near Khargone (Madhya Pradesh). The former measures about 3m in diameter and the latter 2m × 2.2m. The roofs were probably made of hay, branches and leaves and were supported on massive wooden posts, 22cm in diameter, raised at regular intervals around the huts. The open spaces between the posts were provided with mud-plastered bamboo screens. The house floors were made up of silt clay and river gravel, with the surface coated with lime. The huts were provided with one or two-mouthed 'chulhas' as well as storage jars and other earthen vessels. This site was excavated by Mr. H.D. Sankalia, Professor of Deccan College, Pune. This site was the most extensive excavated Chalcolithic site of Indian sub-continent, which is determined to be between 1500 B.C. and 1300 B.C.

27. In which state, the Navdatoli is located ?

- (a) Gujarat (b) Maharashtra
(c) Chhattisgarh (d) Madhya Pradesh

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

28. Megaliths have been identified as-

- (a) Caves for hermits (b) Burial sites
(c) Temple sites (d) None of the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (b)

The megaliths usually refer to the burials made up of large stones in graveyards away from the habitation area. A large fraction of these is assumed to be associated with burial or post-burial rituals including memorials for those whose remains may or may not be available. Few types of these are; Chamber tombs, Dolmens, Stone alignments, Stone circles (cromlech), Pit-circles, etc.

29. Ash mound is associated with the Neolithic site at –

- (a) Budihal (b) Sangana Kallu
(c) Koldihwa (d) Brahmagiri

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (b)

The 'Ash mounds' have been found from a Neolithic site Sangana Kallu located in Ballari district in Karnataka. They have also been found in Piklihal and Utnur. These ash mounds are the burnt relics of seasonal camps of the Neolithic herdsmen community.

30. 'Bhimbetka' is famous for -

- (a) Rock Paintings
- (b) Buddhist Statues
- (c) Minerals
- (d) Origin of Son River

M.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

The rock shelters of Bhimbetka are located in Abdullahganj-Raisen (M.P.). UNESCO has included the shell pictures of Bhimbetka in the list of its World Heritage Site. These caves exhibit the earliest traces of human life on the Indian subcontinent and include the pictures of an elephant, sambar, deer etc. There are 500 pictures in 750 rock shelters.

31. Which one of the following places is famous for pre-historic paintings ?

- (a) Ajanta
- (b) Bhimbetka
- (c) Bagh
- (d) Amravati

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

32. Where are the caves of Bhimbetka situated?

- (a) Bhopal
- (b) Pachmarhi
- (c) Singrauli
- (d) Abdullahganj-Raisen

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

33. In India, from which rock-shelter, pictures has been found the most ?

- (a) Ghagharia
- (b) Bhimbetka
- (c) Lekhahia
- (d) Adamgarh

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

34. Which of the following Indian Archaeologists first visited 'Bhimbetka Caves' and discovered prehistoric significance of its rock paintings?

- (a) Madho Sarup Vatsa
- (b) H.D. Sankalia
- (c) V.S. Wakankar
- (d) V.N. Mishra

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

'Bhimbetka Caves' are located in the Raisen District of MP. They are the best examples of Rock paintings of prehistoric era. It was discovered by V.S. Wakankar in 1957. It is a UNESCO World Heritage Site for its prominent prehistoric Rock Paintings.

35. When did Dr. Vishnu Shridhar Wakankar discover the rock shelters of Bhimbetka?

- (a) 1951-1952
- (b) 1954-1955
- (c) 1960-1961
- (d) 1957-1958

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2025

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

36. Bhimbetka was discovered by

- (a) Dr. H.D. Sankhalia
- (b) Dr. Shyam Sundar Nigam
- (c) Dr. Vishnu S. Wakankar
- (d) Dr. Rajbali Pandey

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre.) 2020

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

37. The Ochre-coloured Pottery (O.C.P.) was christened at:

- (a) Hastinapur
- (b) Ahichhatra
- (c) Noh
- (d) Red Fort

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (a)

Discovery and Naming (Christen) of OCP was done by B.B. Lal in 1950-52 at Hastinapur. Ochre-Coloured Pottery (known to archaeologists as OCP) as the name implies, its main distinguishing feature was its ochre colour, which gives it a first appearance of being badly fired. Other characteristics are its porous character and the fact that it is invariably worn out at the edges.

38. In the Chalcolithic period people of Maharashtra buried their dead under the floor of their houses in the following orientation:

- (a) North to South position
- (b) East to West position
- (c) South to North position
- (d) West to East position

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

The people of Jorwe culture lived in large rectangular houses with wattle and daub walls and thatched roofs. They believed in life after death and therefore buried the dead inside the houses under the floor. Children were buried in two urns that were joined mouth-to-mouth and set horizontally in the pit, while adults were placed in a supine position with their head towards the north (north to south). These sites were found in Daimabad, Inamgaon, Chandoli, Nevasa etc.

39. Which of the following sites has yielded skeleton of the dog along with human skeleton in burial ?

- (a) Brahmagiri
- (b) Burzahom
- (c) Chirand
- (d) Maski

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The Burzahom site is a prehistoric settlement in the village of the same name in Kashmir Valley. Both human and animal skeletons were found here with trepanning (bored hole) marks. In many pits, bones of dogs and antlered deer were found along with human skeletons. The skeletons of humans were found in the burial pits in a sitting position along with the bones of animals. The first excavation at the Burzahom site was carried out by Helmut de Terra and Dr. Thomas Paterson in 1935 AD.

40. The evidence of burying the dog with human body is found from which of the following places ?

- (a) Burzahom (b) Koldihwa
(c) Chaupani-mando (d) Mando

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

41. The evidence of pit dwelling has been obtained from –

- (a) Burzahom (b) Koldihwa
(c) Brahmagiri (d) Sanganakallu

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

42. Correctly match the following :

- | | |
|---------------------|------------------------------|
| (I) | (II) |
| A. Palaeolithic Age | (i) Bhimbetka Caves |
| B. Mesolithic Age | (ii) Burzahom |
| C. Neolithic Age | (iii) Banas Valley |
| D. Chalcolithic Age | (iv) Sohan/Soan River Valley |

Code :

- | | | | |
|----------|------|-------|-------|
| A | B | C | D |
| (a) (i) | (ii) | (iv) | (iii) |
| (b) (iv) | (i) | (ii) | (iii) |
| (c) (iv) | (ii) | (i) | (iii) |
| (d) (i) | (iv) | (iii) | (ii) |

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Correctly matched

Palaeolithic Age	Sohan/Soan River Valley
Mesolithic Age	Bhimbetka Caves
Neolithic Age	Burzahom
Chalcolithic Age	Banas Valley

43. Match list-I with list-II and choose the correct answer using the code given below the lists –

- | | |
|-----------------------|--------------------|
| List-I | List-II |
| (Archaeological site) | (Present location) |
| A. Nevasa | (1) Rajasthan |
| B. Isampur | (2) Tamil Nadu |
| C. Didwana | (3) Maharashtra |
| D. Gudiyam cave | (4) Karnataka |

Code –

- (a) A-(4), B-(3), C-(1), D-(2)
(b) A-(3), B-(2), C-(4), D-(1)
(c) A-(3), B-(4), C-(1), D-(2)
(d) A-(3), B-(4), C-(2), D-(1)

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Correct match is as follows –

Archaeological site	Present location
Nevasa	– Maharashtra
Isampur	– Karnataka
Didwana	– Rajasthan
Gudiyam Cave	– Tamil Nadu

44. Consider the following pairs :

- | | |
|---------------------|------------------|
| (Historical place) | (Well-known for) |
| 1. Burzahom | Rock-cut shrines |
| 2. Chandra-ketugarh | Terracotta art |
| 3. Ganeshwar | Copper artefacts |

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2
(c) 3 only (d) 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

Burzahom is a Neolithic site in Kashmir valley. The site is famous for pit dwelling and Neolithic tool industry and not for rock-cut shrines. Hence pair 1 is not correctly matched. Chandraketugarh is located in the West Bengal. In early historic times, Chandraketugarh was connected to the Ganga by the Vidyadhari river and must have been an important centre of trade and possibly also a political centre. Chandraketugarh was a major centre of terracotta craft. Various kinds of artefacts have been found at the site over the years, including coins, pottery, seals and sealings and figurines made of ivory, wood and bronze. Hence pair 2 is correctly matched. The Ganeshwar-Jodhpura culture was located in Rajasthan. Hundreds of copper objects have been found at this site. Hence pair 3 is correctly matched.

45. Consider the following information:

	Archaeological Site	State	Description
1.	Chandraketugarh	Odisha	Trading Port town
2.	Inamgaon	Maharashtra	Chalcolithic site
3.	Mangadu	Kerala	Megalithic site
4.	Salihundam	Andhra Pradesh	Rock-cut cave shrines

In which of the above rows is the given information correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 3 and 4 (d) 1 and 4

I.A.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

Chandraketugarh is an archaeological site in the North 24 Parganas district of West Bengal (not in Odisha). The archaeological studies suggest that once the destination was an important trading port city with huge walls. Hence, information given in row 1 is not correctly matched.

Inamgaon is a post-Harappan agrarian village and archaeological site located in Pune district of Maharashtra. Inamgaon is one of the most intensively and extensively excavated and well reconstructed Chalcolithic sites of the Deccan plateau. Hence, information given in row 2 is correctly matched.

Mangadu is one of the important excavated Megalithic sites in the Kollam district of Kerala. The Megalithic monuments at Mangadu consisted of 28 hard, compact and uneven laterite blocks. The urn-burials at Mangadu reveal the evidence of post-cremation fragmentary burials. Hence, information given in row 3 is correctly matched.

Salihundam, is a historically important Buddhist site in Srikakulam district of Andhra Pradesh. There are a number of Buddhist stupas and a huge monastic complex on a hillock amidst scenic surroundings. During excavations relic caskets, four stupas, a Chaityagriha, structural temples and a number of sculptures reflecting the three phases of Buddhism-Theravada, Mahayana and Vajrayana were found here. However, there is no rock-cut cave shrines found here. Hence, information given in row 4 is not correctly matched. Thus, option (b) is the correct answer.

46. From which rock shelter of Vindhya, a maximum number of human skeletons have been found?

- (a) Morahana Pahar (b) Ghagharia
(c) Baghahi Khor (d) Lekhahia

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

According to 'Puratatva Vimarsh' by J.N. Pandey, 17 human skeletons were obtained from rock shelter 1 of Lekhahiya in the Vindhya region. Some of these were in relatively pristine condition while most of the others were warped. According to John R. Lucas of the University of Oregon (USA), remnants of 27 human skeletons were found in Lekhahiya.

47. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A) : The stone age people of the Vindhya migrated to the Ganga Valley in terminal Pleistocene period.

Reason (R) : Due to climatic change, it was dry phase in this period.

Choose the correct answer from the code given below.

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
(c) (A) is true but (R) is false

(d) (A) is false but (R) is true

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (a)

Stone age people of the Vindhya migrated to the Ganga Valley in the terminal Pleistocene period because of climatic change Vindhyan Valley had become dry.

48. Which of these departments/ministries deals with Archaeological Survey of India as an accessory office ?

- (a) Culture
(b) Tourism
(c) Science and Technology
(d) Human Resource and Development

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

The Archaeological Survey of India (ASI), under the Ministry of Culture, is a premier organization for the archaeological research and protection of the cultural heritage of the nation. In 1871, the Archaeological Survey was established as a separate department and Alexander Cunningham was appointed as its first Director-General. In 1901, during the tenure of Lord Curzon, it was centralized and designated as the Archaeological Survey of India. In 1902 John Marshall assumed office of its Director General.

49. Who is called the 'Father of Indian Archaeology'?

- (a) Alexander Cunningham
(b) John Marshall
(c) Mortimer Wheeler
(d) James Prinsep

M.P.P.C.S (Pre)-2017

Ans. (a)

Alexander Cunningham (1814-1893 AD) was appointed as British army officer with Bengal Engineer Group. He is known as 'Father of Indian Archaeology'.

50. Where is National Human Museum situated ?

- (a) Guwahati (b) Bastar
(c) Bhopal (d) Chennai

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

National Museum of Mankind known as Indira Gandhi Rastriya Manav Sangrahalaya is located in Bhopal (M.P.). It is an autonomous organization under the Ministry of Culture.

51. Country's biggest museum showing history of human development, The Indira Gandhi Rastriya Manav Snagrahalaya is located at which place?

- (a) Bhopal (b) New Delhi
(c) Mumbai (d) Ahmedabad

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.